

Role Guide 6: Documentary Evidence Research Assistant

Step-by-step instructions for the Documentary RA role in the ABF-FST Digital Respondent Portal.

STUDY	Developing and Validating the Agribusiness Bankability Framework for Food Systems Transformation through Novel Financing Models in Zimbabwe (ABF-FST)
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Screenshots in this document use **fictional demonstration data**. Organisation and person names, phone numbers and figures shown in them are not real study records.

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1. Your role at a glance

You build the documentary corpus of 50–75 coded sources: record each document, judge its authenticity before it can be included, explain your reasoning in a memo, and code it with the Document, Digital Platform & Media Analysis Tool in KoboToolbox.

You can

- See the KII/Doc Dashboard, the Documents register and document records.
- Create document records, assess authenticity, include or exclude, write memos.
- Attach, replace or remove a document's source file.
- Use Auto-fill (once switched on) to have AI draft the coding form, then review, edit and submit it.
- Download PDFs of completed document coding forms.

You cannot

- See or edit KII records, questionnaire QA, the Main-400 register, costs or exports.
- Include a document before its authenticity has been assessed.
- Send an AI draft to KoboToolbox without reviewing it: nothing is submitted until you select Submit.

Where this fits

The System Manual explains how the whole system works. This guide covers only what you do. Ask the Field Coordinator or PI when something is outside your role.

2. Signing in and your screens

Signing in

1. Open <https://research.agribizframework.com/admin/login> in any modern browser (Chrome, Edge, Firefox or Safari), on a computer, tablet or phone.
2. Type your **Username** and **Password**, then select **Sign in**.

The image shows a web browser window displaying the internal sign-in page. At the top, a dark blue header bar contains the text 'CHINHOMY UNIVERSITY OF TECHNOLOGY' and 'ABF-FST Research Operations Centre'. Below the header, the main content area is light gray. In the center, there is a white rectangular box titled 'Internal sign in'. Inside this box, there are two input fields: 'Username' with the text 'pi.admin' entered, and 'Password' which is empty. Below these fields is a dark blue button labeled 'Sign in'.

Figure 1. The sign-in screen for all internal staff.

3. You arrive on your start screen: **KII/Doc Dashboard**. The bar across the top lists only the screens your role (Documentary RA) can open.

Accounts

There is no self-registration. The PI / System Admin creates every account and sets its role. Ask the PI if you need an account, a different role, or a password reset.

Finding your way around

- The **top bar** shows your username and role, and the screens you can use. It is not a full menu with some items greyed out: anything absent is simply not part of your role.
- Most screens have a **← Back to ...** link at the top that returns you to the screen you came from.
- Registers show **20 rows per page**. Use **Previous** and **Next** at the foot of the list, and the **Search** box above it.
- **Change password** (top right) lets you set a new password at any time. Choose a long password you do not use anywhere else.
- **Sign out** (top right) ends your session. Always sign out on a shared or public computer.
- If you are inactive for a while you may be asked to sign in again. This protects research data on unattended devices.

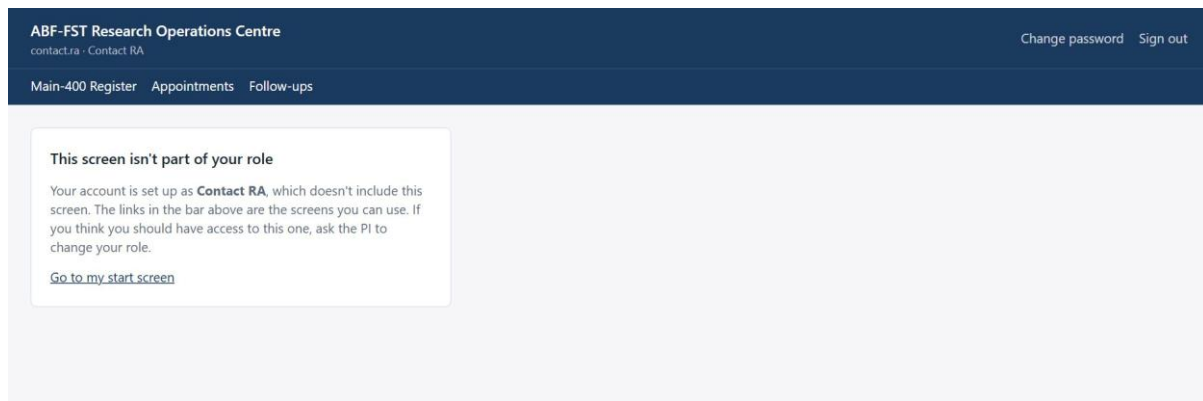


Figure 2. Opening a screen outside your role (for example from an old bookmark) shows this card instead of the screen.

Your screens

Screen	What you use it for
KII/Doc Dashboard	Documents by type and QA status against the 50–75 target.
Form PDFs	Completed document coding forms.
Documents	The corpus; create and manage records.

Changing your password

1. Select **Change password** in the top right corner.
2. Enter your **Current password**, then the **New password** twice, and select **Change password**.

The screenshot shows the 'Change Password' screen. The top navigation bar includes 'pladmin - PI / System Admin' and 'Change password Sign out'. The main navigation bar lists various screens: Executive, Sampling, Reports, Contact, QA Dashboard, KII/Doc Dashboard, Main-400 Register, Organisations, Appointments, Follow-ups, Form PDFs, QA Queue, QA Exceptions, and KII Register. A 'Back to Dashboard' link is visible. The 'Change Password' section contains three input fields: 'Current password', 'New password', and 'Confirm new password'. A 'Change password' button is located below the input fields.

Figure 3. Change Password screen.

3. Use the new password next time you sign in. If you have forgotten your password, ask the PI to reset it.

3. Your routine

A suggested rhythm. Adjust it to the Field Coordinator's plan.

When	What to do
When you find a source	Create the record with a precise reference and an evidence extract.
Assessment	Verify authenticity against the source; mark Verified or Disputed; write the memo.
Inclusion	Include or Exclude with reasons in the memo.
Source file	Upload the source. Wrong one? Select Remove file and upload the right one.
Coding	Either Code this document (you answer the form, DOC ID filled in) or Auto-fill (AI drafts, you review every field, then Submit).

4. Step-by-step tasks

4.1 Reading the dashboard

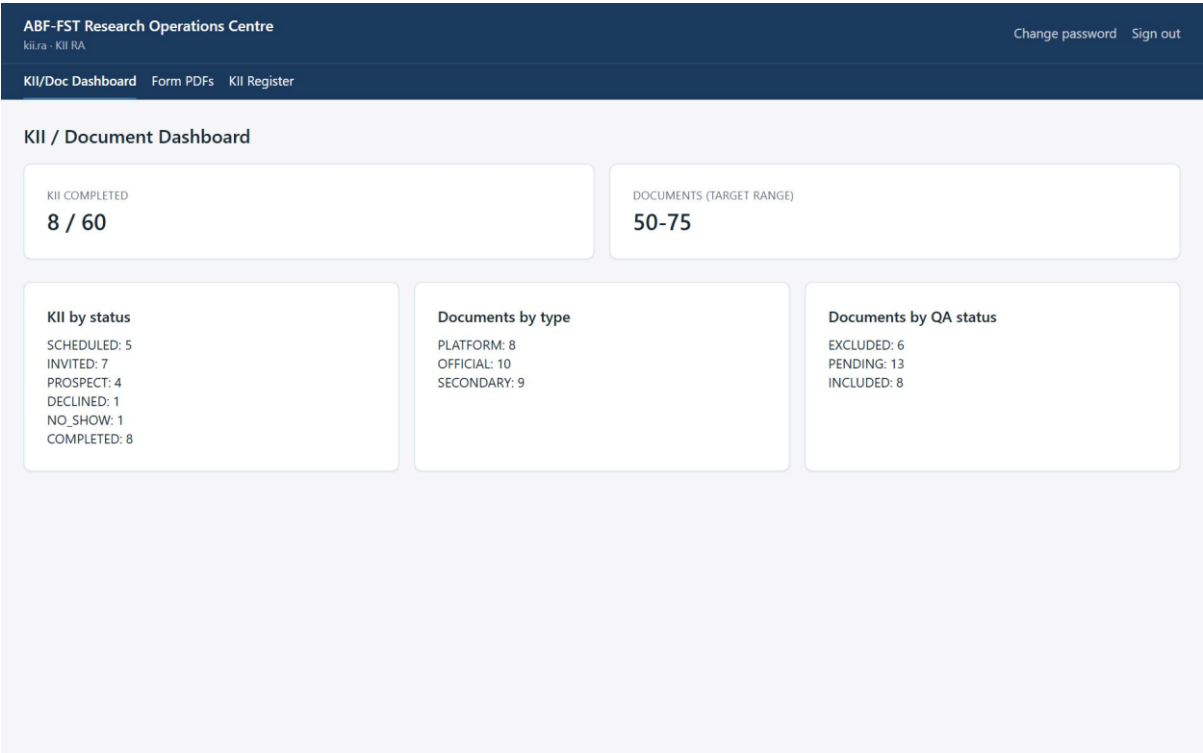


Figure 4. Documents by type and by QA status.

4.2 Adding a document

1. Select Documents → New document.

The screenshot shows the 'New Documentary Evidence Record' form within the 'ABF-FST Research Operations Centre'. The user is logged in as 'documents.ra - Documentary RA'. The form includes the following fields:

- Title:** Text input field.
- Author / speaker:** Text input field.
- Source URL / reference:** Text input field.
- Document type:** Dropdown menu with 'OFFICIAL' selected.
- Geographic scope:** Text input field.
- Evidence extract:** Text input field.

Figure 5. New Documentary Evidence Record.

2. Enter **Title**, **Author / speaker**, **Source URL / reference**, **Document type** (OFFICIAL, SECONDARY or PLATFORM), **Geographic scope** and an **Evidence extract**, then select **Create document record**. The document ID (e.g. DOC-0025) is generated.

4.3 Attaching the source file, and removing a wrong one

1. On the document's page, under **Source file**, select **Choose File** and pick the source: a PDF, a scan or photo (JPG or PNG), a Word (.docx) or Excel (.xlsx) file, or a text or CSV file. Audio and video can be attached as a reference. The limit is 20 MB. The file is stored privately on the server.

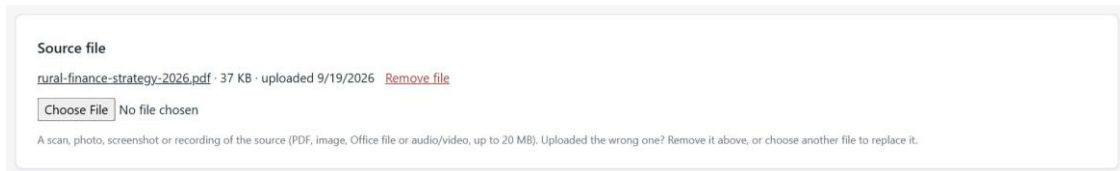


Figure 6. Source file: the file name, size and date, with Remove file beside it.

2. A bar shows how much of the file has been sent. A large file on a slow connection can take a minute or two: wait until it says **Saving...** and the file name appears.
3. Attached the wrong one? Select the red **Remove file** link beside the file name and confirm. The file is deleted from the server and the record says “No file uploaded yet”. Then choose the right file.
4. Choosing another file straight away also replaces the old one.

What goes with a removed file

An AI draft (see below) made from the removed or replaced file is discarded too, so a draft of the wrong document can never be reviewed and submitted for the right one. A draft that has already been submitted to KoboToolbox is kept as the record of what was filed. Removals are recorded in the audit log with the file name.

4.4 Assessing and including a document

1. In **Documents**, select **Manage** on the record.

ABF-FST Research Operations Centre
documents.ra · Documentary RA

Change password Sign out

KII/Doc Dashboard Form PDFs Documents

← Back to KII/Doc Dashboard

Documentary Evidence Corpus

Search title, ID or author [New document](#)

Document ID	Title	Type	Authenticity	QA status	
DOC-0001	Agricultural Finance Strategy 2025–2030 (demo 1)	OFFICIAL	VERIFIED	PENDING	Manage
DOC-0002	Warehouse Receipt System Annual Report (demo 2)	SECONDARY	VERIFIED	INCLUDED	Manage
DOC-0003	Contract Farming Guidelines (demo 3)	PLATFORM	UNVERIFIED	PENDING	Manage
DOC-0004	Agro-dealer Credit Survey (demo 4)	OFFICIAL	DISPUTED	EXCLUDED	Manage
DOC-0005	Value Chain Finance Review: Horticulture (demo 5)	SECONDARY	VERIFIED	INCLUDED	Manage
DOC-0006	Mobile Money Adoption among Smallholders (demo 6)	PLATFORM	VERIFIED	INCLUDED	Manage
DOC-0007	Crop Insurance Market Assessment (demo 7)	OFFICIAL	UNVERIFIED	PENDING	Manage
DOC-0008	Tobacco Contract Finance Statement (demo 8)	SECONDARY	DISPUTED	EXCLUDED	Manage
DOC-0009	Dairy Sector Investment Brief (demo 9)	PLATFORM	VERIFIED	INCLUDED	Manage
DOC-0010	Bank Lending to Agriculture Bulletin (demo 10)	OFFICIAL	VERIFIED	PENDING	Manage
DOC-0011	Cooperative Governance Toolkit (demo 11)	SECONDARY	UNVERIFIED	PENDING	Manage
DOC-0012	Blended Finance Case Study (demo 12)	PLATFORM	DISPUTED	EXCLUDED	Manage
DOC-0013	Agricultural Finance Strategy 2025–2030 (demo 13)	OFFICIAL	VERIFIED	PENDING	Manage
DOC-0014	Warehouse Receipt System Annual Report (demo 14)	SECONDARY	VERIFIED	INCLUDED	Manage

Figure 7. Documentary Evidence Corpus.

2. Assess authenticity: select **Mark verified** or **Mark disputed**.

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documents.ra · Documentary RA

Change password Sign out

KII/Doc Dashboard Form PDFs Documents

← Back to Documents

Contract Farming Guidelines (demo 3)
DOC-0003 · PLATFORM

Authenticity: UNVERIFIED

[Mark verified](#) [Mark disputed](#)

QA status: PENDING

[Include](#) [Exclude](#)

Cannot be included until authenticity is assessed.

Source file

No file uploaded yet.

[Choose File](#) No file chosen

A scan, photo, screenshot or recording of the source (PDF, image, Office file or audio/video, up to 20 MB). Uploaded the wrong one? Remove it above, or choose another file to replace it.

Coding

Opens the KoboToolbox Document Analysis Tool with this record's DOC-ID and details already filled in.

[Code this document](#) [Auto-fill](#)

Auto-fill has AI read the uploaded source file and draft the whole form for you to review, edit and submit yourself — nothing reaches KoboToolbox until you do.

Figure 8. Document record: authenticity, QA status, memo and coding form.

- Set the QA status: **Include** or **Exclude**. A document cannot be included until authenticity has been assessed.
- Write the **Interpretive memo** (dispute reasons, interpretation notes) and select **Save memo**.
- Code the document (next two sections). The completed form's PDF then appears on the record, under **Completed coding form (KoboToolbox)**.

4.5 Coding a document: two ways

The **Coding** panel offers two buttons for the Document, Digital Platform & Media Analysis Tool:

Button	What it does	Use it when
Code this document	Opens the KoboToolbox Document Analysis Tool with the DOC ID, title, author, date and source already filled in. You answer every other question yourself.	You code by hand, or the source cannot be read by the AI.
Auto-fill	Has the AI read the uploaded source file and draft answers to the whole form. You review, edit and submit.	A source file is uploaded and you want a fast first draft. The button only appears once the administrator has switched AI drafting on.

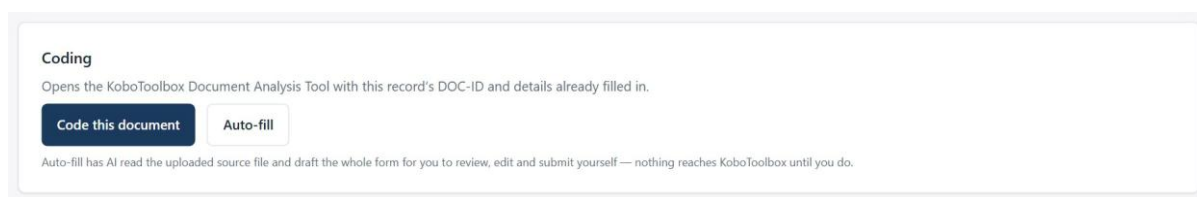


Figure 9. The Coding panel: Code this document, and Auto-fill.

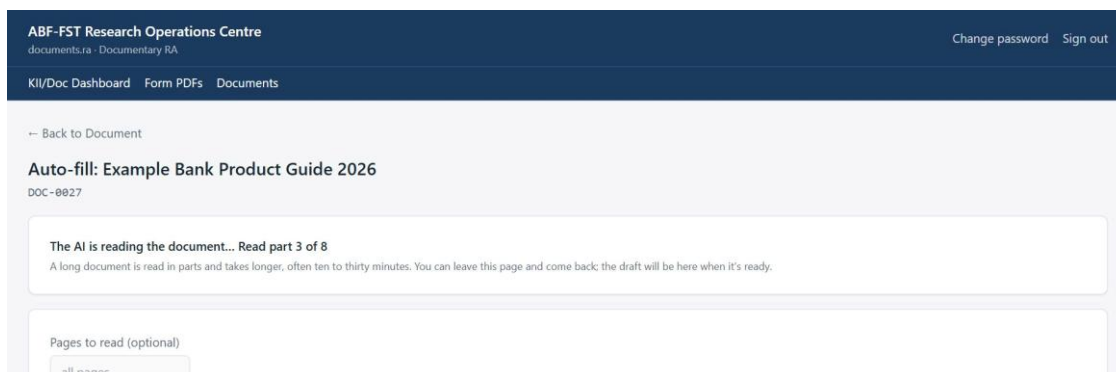
4.6 Auto-fill: the AI drafts, you review

1. Attach the source file (above). Select **Auto-fill** in the **Coding** panel; the review screen opens.
2. If the file is a PDF of more than 100 pages, enter the **Pages to read**, for example 10-90. The AI reads up to 100 pages at a time, so either choose the pages that make up this evidence unit, such as one chapter, or tick **Read the whole document in parts** (see “Coding a very long document” below). Its locators use the original page numbers. For shorter files, leave the box empty to read everything.

The screenshot shows the 'Auto-fill: Example Annual Sector Report (long PDF)' screen. At the top, it says 'DOC-0026'. Below is a 'Pages to read (optional)' input field with 'e.g. 1-100' as a placeholder. A note explains: 'This PDF has 240 pages and the AI can read up to 100 at a time. Enter the pages that make up this evidence unit, such as a chapter, or read the whole document in parts. Locators will use the original page numbers.' There is a checked checkbox for 'Read the whole document in parts' with a note: 'The AI codes each part of about 80 pages, then combines them into one draft. Leave the page box empty for all 240 pages, or enter a longer range. About 240 pages in 3 parts: roughly 6 minutes, and it uses about 4 times the AI of an ordinary draft. Because the ratings are judged across parts, check them especially carefully.' At the bottom is a 'Generate AI draft' button. A message at the very bottom says: 'No draft yet. Click "Generate AI draft" above.'

Figure 10. A 240-page PDF: enter a page range, or read the whole document in parts.

3. Select **Generate AI draft**. The AI reads in the background, usually one to five minutes. You can leave the page and come back; the draft will be there.



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Change password Sign out

KI/Doc Dashboard Form PDFs Documents

← Back to Document

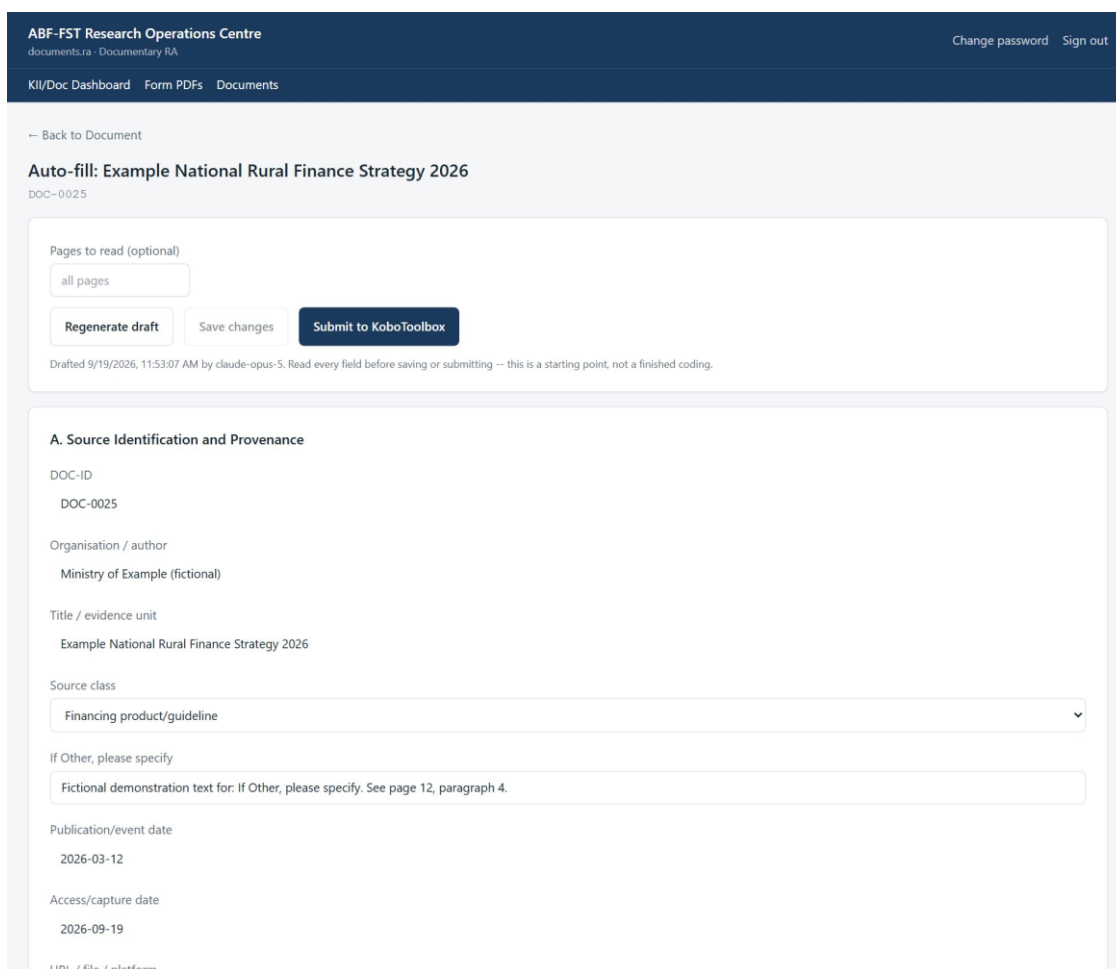
Auto-fill: Example Bank Product Guide 2026
DOC-0027

The AI is reading the document... Read part 3 of 8
A long document is read in parts and takes longer, often ten to thirty minutes. You can leave this page and come back; the draft will be here when it's ready.

Pages to read (optional)
all pages

Figure 11. The AI is reading the document.

4. Read the draft. It has every section of the KoboToolbox form, A to L. The DOC ID, author, title, date and source come from the record and cannot be changed here; everything else you can edit.



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KI/Doc Dashboard Form PDFs Documents

← Back to Document

Auto-fill: Example National Rural Finance Strategy 2026
DOC-0025

Pages to read (optional)
all pages

Regenerate draft Save changes Submit to KoboToolbox

Drafted 9/19/2026, 11:53:07 AM by claude-opus-5. Read every field before saving or submitting -- this is a starting point, not a finished coding.

A. Source Identification and Provenance

DOC-ID
DOC-0025

Organisation / author
Ministry of Example (fictional)

Title / evidence unit
Example National Rural Finance Strategy 2026

Source class
Financing product/guideline

If Other, please specify
Fictional demonstration text for: If Other, please specify. See page 12, paragraph 4.

Publication/event date
2026-03-12

Access/capture date
2026-09-19

URL / file / platform

Figure 12. The review screen: the draft, ready to check and edit.

5. Check the judgements, not just the facts: the strength ratings (Sections D and H), the hypothesis codes (Section K) and the locators. Open the source and confirm a few page or paragraph references.

D. Agribusiness Bankability Index — ABI Core Dimensions

D1 Governance & Risk Management — Strength

Moderate

D1 Governance & Risk Management — Evidence summary

Fictional demonstration text for: D1 Governance & Risk Management — Evidence summary. See page 12, paragraph 4.

D1 Governance & Risk Management — Locator

Fictional demonstration text for: D1 Governance & Risk Management — Locator. See page 12, paragraph 4.

D2 Contractual Credibility — Strength

Moderate

D2 Contractual Credibility — Evidence summary

Fictional demonstration text for: D2 Contractual Credibility — Evidence summary. See page 12, paragraph 4.

D2 Contractual Credibility — Locator

Fictional demonstration text for: D2 Contractual Credibility — Locator. See page 12, paragraph 4.

D3 Cash-Flow Predictability — Strength

Weak

D3 Cash-Flow Predictability — Evidence summary

Fictional demonstration text for: D3 Cash-Flow Predictability — Evidence summary. See page 12, paragraph 4.

D3 Cash-Flow Predictability — Locator

Figure 13. Section D: ratings and locators, all editable.

6. Check the numbers in Section J against the source. Add or remove metrics as needed.

J. Quantitative Evidence Extraction Add metric

Metric: Other

If Other, please specify: Share of farmers with a bank account

Value: 62%

Unit/currency: percent

Period: 2025

Population/geography: National

Target/forecast/actual: Actual

Locator: Table 3, page 21

Remove this metric

Metric: Other

If Other, please specify: Target for warehouse receipt volume

Value: 150,000

Unit/currency: tonnes

Period: 2030

Population/geography: National

Target/forecast/actual: Target

Locator: Paragraph 9.3, page 44

Remove this metric

Figure 14. Section J: quantitative metrics.

7. Select **Save changes** to keep your edits and finish later. When you are satisfied, select **Submit to KoboToolbox** and confirm. Your reviewed answers are sent as a completed record.

8. The record appears at once under **Completed coding form (KoboToolbox)** on the document page and in **Form PDFs**, found by its DOC ID. The portal's copy of the Document Analysis Tool is refreshed the moment you submit. If a coding you submitted is later deleted in KoboToolbox, the next sync (automatic, or **Sync now** on **Form PDFs**) unlocks the document so it can be coded again.

The draft is a starting point, not a finding

Sections D to K are this study's documentary analysis. The AI drafts them; you are responsible for them. Change any rating you disagree with. A draft where everything is rated as strongly supportive deserves a second look.

Nothing reaches KoboToolbox until you select **Submit**. Each draft and submission is recorded in the audit log, so the study can say exactly which records were AI-assisted.

Submit once. A second submission would create a duplicate record for the document, and the screen shows "Already submitted" to stop it.

File type	Can the AI read it?	Locators
PDF	Yes, up to 100 pages at a time; longer files by page range, or read whole in parts (up to 1,500 pages).	Original page and paragraph numbers.
JPG, PNG (scan or photo)	Yes. Very large photos are shrunk automatically.	Whatever the image shows.
Word (.docx), Excel (.xlsx), text, CSV	Yes, as text.	No page numbers: headings, paragraph or section numbers, sheet names.
Audio or video	No. Upload a transcript (PDF, Word or text) and keep the recording as the source reference.	-
Old .doc or .xls	No. Save as a PDF or as .docx / .xlsx and upload that.	-

Coding a very long document

The AI can take in 100 pages at a time. A report of several hundred or a thousand pages therefore needs one of two approaches:

- **One record per chapter (recommended).** Create a document record for each part you want coded, for example "NDS2 – Agriculture chapter". Upload the same PDF to each, enter that part's page range, and review and submit each one. Each part gets its own DOC ID, its own coding and its own row in the Excel export.
- **Read the whole document in parts.** Tick **Read the whole document in parts**. Leave **Pages to read** empty for every page, or enter a longer range such as 1-600 (up to 1,500 pages). The AI codes each part of about 80 pages, then combines them into one draft for the record. The screen tells you how many parts it will take and asks you to confirm, then shows progress ("Read part 3 of 8", then "Combining the parts into one draft"). Expect roughly ten to thirty minutes, and you can leave the page.

A combined draft needs extra care

Because the ratings are judged across the parts rather than from every page at once, check the strength ratings (Sections D and H), the hypothesis codes (Section K) and the locators more carefully than for a single chapter. The draft states which pages it covers; confirm that this is the evidence unit you meant.

A whole-document read costs about the number of parts plus one times an ordinary draft. If any part fails, the whole draft fails and nothing is saved, so you never receive a coding that silently skipped pages.

Whether a whole-document coding is appropriate for a given source is a methodology decision for the PI; for a report that covers many topics, one record per chapter usually gives a sharper analysis.

If Auto-fill shows a message

You see	What it means	What to do
"Pages to read (required)", or "This PDF has N pages..."	The PDF is longer than 100 pages.	Enter a page range of up to 100 pages, or tick Read the whole document in parts.
"...over the 1500-page ceiling..."	The PDF is longer than the most that can be read in one draft.	Enter a page range, or make one record per chapter.
"Read part 4 of 12" or "Combining the parts..."	A long document is being read in parts. Nothing is wrong.	Wait, or leave the page and come back.
"The AI's answer was cut off..."	The range was too big to answer in one go.	Try a narrower range.
"A draft is already being generated"	You or a colleague already started one.	Wait for it to finish (about five minutes; up to half an hour for a document read in parts).
"The last attempt failed: ..."	The AI request did not complete.	Select Generate AI draft again. If it keeps failing, tell the administrator the message.
No Auto-fill button	AI drafting has not been switched on, or there is no source file yet.	Attach the file; otherwise ask the administrator.
Submit is refused by KoboToolbox	KoboToolbox did not accept the record.	Tell the administrator; your draft is kept.

Cost

Each draft is a paid request on the study's AI account. A short chapter costs little; a full 100 pages costs several times more; a whole document read in parts costs about the number of parts plus one times an ordinary draft. Choose the pages you need.

4.7 Downloading or emailing completed forms (Form PDFs)

1. Select **Form PDFs**. You see the completed Document Analysis Tool forms from KoboToolbox, newest first.
2. At the top, the sync panel shows whether the portal holds the same forms as KoboToolbox: for example "✓ In sync with KoboToolbox — KoboToolbox holds 12 · the portal holds 12". Each row also says "✓ saved in portal" once the portal has an identical copy. If the panel says "Not in sync", select **Sync now**; it takes a few seconds.
3. Select **Download PDF** to save a readable copy: sections, questions, the chosen answers as words (not codes) and repeated groups.

4. Select **Email to me** to send the PDF to the email address on your account.

The same PDF is available from the record itself: the case page (questionnaire), the KII page (KII Guide) or the document page (coding form).

How the sync works

The portal keeps its own copy of the questionnaire, KII Guide and Document Analysis Tool, and refreshes it every 15 minutes and whenever someone selects Sync now. A submission edited in KoboToolbox is updated here; one deleted in KoboToolbox is flagged as removed. You never need to sync before downloading a PDF: the PDF is always read from KoboToolbox at that moment.

4.8 Judging authenticity

- **Official:** from a government body, regulator or the organisation itself — check it on the issuer's own site or registry.
- **Secondary:** reports, studies, articles — check the publisher, author and date.
- **Platform:** websites, social media, digital platforms — capture the URL and date accessed; corroborate claims elsewhere.
- Mark **Disputed** when authorship, date or content cannot be confirmed, and say why in the memo.

5. Rules you must follow

- Record the exact source reference so another researcher can find the same document.
- Do not store copyrighted documents outside the study's approved storage.
- Treat everything in the portal as **confidential research data**. Do not screenshot, copy, print or forward names, phone numbers, email addresses or answers except as your role requires.
- Never share your username or password, and never sign in for someone else.
- Use the respondent's contact details **only** to manage their participation in this study (invitations, reminders, appointments).
- Never tell a respondent, lender or anyone else that answers affect financing. The study generates **no score, rating or financing decision**.
- If a respondent asks to withdraw, stop contacting them and tell the Field Coordinator or PI the same day so the withdrawal is recorded.
- Report a lost device, a suspected account compromise, or data sent to the wrong person to the PI immediately.

6. Troubleshooting

Situation	Likely cause	What to do
Include is greyed out	Authenticity not assessed.	Mark verified or disputed first.
No coding form PDF on the record	The form was not submitted with this DOC ID.	Use Code this document or Auto-fill so the DOC ID is filled in for you.
No Auto-fill button	No source file yet, or AI drafting is not switched on.	Attach the file; otherwise ask the administrator.
Auto-fill asks for Pages to read	The PDF has more than 100 pages.	Enter a range of up to 100 pages, such as one chapter, or tick Read the whole document in parts.
Uploaded the wrong file	It happens.	Select Remove file beside the file name, then upload the right one.
"This screen isn't part of your role"	The screen belongs to another role (often an old bookmark or shared link).	Select Go to my start screen. If you need that screen, ask the PI about your role.
"Too many sign-in attempts from this network"	Sign-in is rate-limited per network; an office shares one address.	Wait a minute and try again. A wrong password says so explicitly.
A register shows fewer rows than expected	Registers show 20 rows per page; a Contact RA sees only assigned cases.	Use Next, or search. Ask the Field Coordinator to assign the case.
A button is greyed out	A required step is missing (a note, an authenticity decision, a selection).	Read the message beside the button; complete the missing step first.
"KoboToolbox couldn't be reached"	KoboToolbox is slow or the connection token has changed.	Try again in a few minutes. If it persists, tell the PI.
Form PDFs says "Not in sync with KoboToolbox yet"	The counts differ: a form was submitted or changed in KoboToolbox since the last sync (it runs every 15 minutes).	Select Sync now. If it still differs, or says it couldn't reach KoboToolbox, try again in a few minutes and tell the PI if it persists.
A document says "Already submitted" and its answers are locked	Its coding was already sent to KoboToolbox; changing it here would not change that record.	To redo the coding, delete that record in KoboToolbox, then select Sync now on Form PDFs. The document unlocks.
A page keeps loading	A slow or dropped connection.	Refresh the page. Your saved work is not lost; unsaved typing may be.
A file upload seems stuck	A large file on a slow connection takes time; the bar shows how much has been sent.	Wait for Saving... and the file name. If it fails, try again or upload a smaller version.

7. Quick reference

Sign in	https://research.agribizframework.com/admin/login
You start on	KII/Doc Dashboard
Target	50–75 coded documents
Types	OFFICIAL, SECONDARY, PLATFORM
Order	Create → attach source → assess authenticity → include/exclude → memo → code (by hand or Auto-fill)
Auto-fill	AI drafts; you review every field; only Submit sends it
Help	Field Coordinator; PI: Happyson Saina, 0773943709, abffst.research.cut@gmail.com